



"Inside the Mind of the Bombers", October 13, 2008

"We must ponder over the madness of 'us Vs them' in God's name. But who is responsible for injecting communal hatred and instigating violence?"

K.S.THAMPI, Chennai

Dangerous Minds

Terrorists don't have anything to do with religion, caste, creed and even with the country ("Inside The Mind of the Bombers", October 13). But what forces a person to adopt path of terror? Is it political, economical, social and religious exploitation that gives birth to such a dangerous mind where a person agrees to kill innocent people for the sake of religion?

GAUTAM SACHDEV, *on e-mail*

Dynamic legislation, stringent punishment and police action will not be enough unless every citizen becomes a watchdog to prevent, or detect and report, terrorist activity which goes on unhindered—breeding and nurturing in his neighbourhood ("Homemade and Deadly" October 13).

Y.G. CHOUKSEY, Pune

Terrorism can only be defeated by involvement, sensitisation and providing a feeling of belonging to those people on whose behalf these terrorists claim to be acting and among whom the terrorists seek shelter as they plan and execute their murderous attacks. There is an urgent need to evolve an effective anti-terrorist strategy which certainly requires us to look even more deeply into devising effective policing, beefing up security and formulating and implementing wise policies. India's war against terror has just begun and I strongly feel that our security forces and society along with political leadership have to play an effective part in investigating the cause of terrorism.

DR. VITULL K. GUPTA, *Bhatinda*

Madrasas and masjids must desist from whipping up communal passion among the youth ("The

Ancestry of Hate", October 13). They should spread harmony, not hate. Muslims must come out of their self-made cocoon to improve matters for the oft-mistaken community.

S. LAKSHMI, *on e-mail*

The main reason behind Muslim youth being misled to become terrorists to kill their own countrymen is the result of religious indoctrination that is dinned into their psyche at their homes, madrasas and masjids. They are radicals, not by choice but by default. There is no justification in taking upon the task of 'jihad' for an aberration in society or mindless wicked act of a religious despot. Muslims must take advantage of every generous avenue provided in the democratic set-up to excel and make their lives better, rather than clinging to outdated ideas and ideals.

K.V. RAGHURAM, *Wayanad*

Indian Dream

Azim H. Premji is of the opinion that India will transform itself when the government stops thinking its schools are for the poor ("Transforming India", October 6). True, if we compare what the government schools have meant both for the people and the government in the past and what it means now, we will find a sharp contrast. Teaching standards have fallen over the years; the authorities have been more or less indifferent and like always it is the students who are at the receiving end. If we want to create social, economic and political equity, we need to strive hard to ensure quality education in our government schools. The need of the hour is urgent action not just empty words. Once we achieve this, the rest will follow in no time.

S.R. KOUSHIK, Chennai